

Ukrainian diaspora engagement tools are maturing, with platforms like Strichka mapping barriers to return and communication gaps. Simultaneously, ongoing Russian strikes and refugee poverty in Moldova underscore persistent brain drain pressures. Women-led entrepreneurship signals untapped human capital for retention strategies.

Strichka research identifies specific barriers preventing Ukrainians abroad from reconnecting with Ukraine — actionable data for Return and Retain policymakers.

RETURN

Strichka Platform Maps Diaspora Return Barriers

Digital platform Strichka published research identifying tools connecting Ukrainians abroad with Ukraine and key factors preventing return. This provides rare empirical data on diaspora reactivation obstacles, covering communication gaps, trust deficits, and information needs.

3R: Direct Return signal: empirical barrier mapping enables targeted policy interventions for diaspora reactivation programs.

RUBRYKA.COM

Fall 2026 Ukraine Action Summit Grows Diaspora Networks

The Fall 2026 Ukraine Action Summit facilitated growing connections within the Ukrainian diaspora support community in the US, with the American Coalition for Ukraine highlighting sustained post-summit engagement as a driver of diaspora mobilization.

3R: Return-adjacent: strengthened diaspora networks are foundational infrastructure for eventual repatriation and skills transfer initiatives.

FACEBOOK.COM

RECRUIT

Women Drive 60% of New SME Registrations in Wartime Ukraine

Global Voices reports women account for nearly 60% of newly registered sole proprietors in Ukraine after five years of war. This demographic shift signals an emerging female entrepreneurial talent pool requiring targeted upskilling, mentorship, and access-to-finance recruitment pipelines.

3R: Recruit signal: untapped female entrepreneurial talent represents a critical domestic skills pipeline for reconstruction-phase workforce planning.

GLOBALVOICES.ORG

North Macedonia SME Upskilling Gaps — Transferable Lesson for Ukraine

OECD's SME Policy Index flags that focusing only on labour market entry neglects upskilling and reskilling of existing workers. Though focused on North Macedonia, this directly mirrors Ukraine's reconstruction challenge of converting wartime workers into high-productivity SME employees.

3R: Recruit policy parallel: Ukraine's SME recovery programs should integrate reskilling mandates, not just job placement metrics.

OECD.ORG

Ukrainian Language Classes Target Russian-Speaking Diaspora

An Instagram-promoted initiative offers Ukrainian language courses targeting Russian-speaking Ukrainians abroad, from Cyrillic basics to everyday fluency. Language barriers are a known obstacle to diaspora reintegration and professional recruitment back into Ukrainian institutions.

3R: Recruit enabler: language fluency programs reduce reintegration friction for diaspora professionals considering return to Ukrainian workplaces.

INSTAGRAM.COM

RETAIN

Ukrainian Refugees in Moldova Face Deep Multidimensional Poverty

UNHCR/HECA 2026 data reveals Ukrainian refugees in Moldova experience severe multidimensional and monetary poverty. Prolonged economic precarity entrenches diaspora settlement abroad, directly undermining return intentions and enabling permanent brain drain of skilled Ukrainians.

3R: Retain risk: poverty-driven entrenchment abroad converts temporary displacement into permanent emigration of working-age Ukrainians.

RELIEFWEB.INT

Russian Strikes on Kyiv Kill Eight, Damage Civilian Infrastructure

Russian drone and missile strikes killed eight people in Kyiv and northeast Ukraine, damaging a maternity clinic. Continued attacks on civilian infrastructure are the primary structural driver of outmigration and the core barrier to retaining skilled workers inside Ukraine.

3R: Retain barrier: sustained infrastructure destruction sustains emigration pressure on skilled urban professionals, particularly women and families.

REUTERS.COM

Brutal Winter Ahead Threatens Ukraine's Urban Workforce Stability

Atlantic Council warns Ukraine faces a brutal winter with depleted air defenses, risking intensified bombardment of cities. Energy and shelter insecurity during winter months historically spikes outmigration decisions among skilled professionals and families with children.

3R: Retain crisis signal: winter bombardment cycles are recurring triggers for skilled workforce emigration spikes — advance mitigation needed.

ATLANTICCOUNCIL.ORG

GLOBAL CONTEXT

5 Million Sudanese Return to Broken Places — Cautionary Parallel

IOM reports 5.1 million Sudanese returned home despite 8.6 million still displaced, returning to damaged infrastructure and scarce services. This case illustrates risks of premature or under-supported return — a critical planning lesson for Ukraine's post-conflict repatriation strategy.

3R: Global context for Return: Ukraine must ensure absorption capacity — housing, jobs, services — before scaling repatriation incentives.

IOM.INT

War Accelerates LGBTQ+ Acceptance in Ukraine — Social Cohesion Shift

OSU Slavic Center highlights summer 2026 reading on how war is increasing LGBTQ+ acceptance in Ukraine. Shifting social norms affect the retention of LGBTQ+ professionals and diaspora members considering return, as inclusive workplaces become a factor in location decisions.

3R: Retain/Return social signal: evolving inclusivity norms may improve Ukraine's attractiveness for diaspora professionals from liberal Western environments.

SLAVICCENTER.OSU.EDU
